

Nokia 6680 / 6681

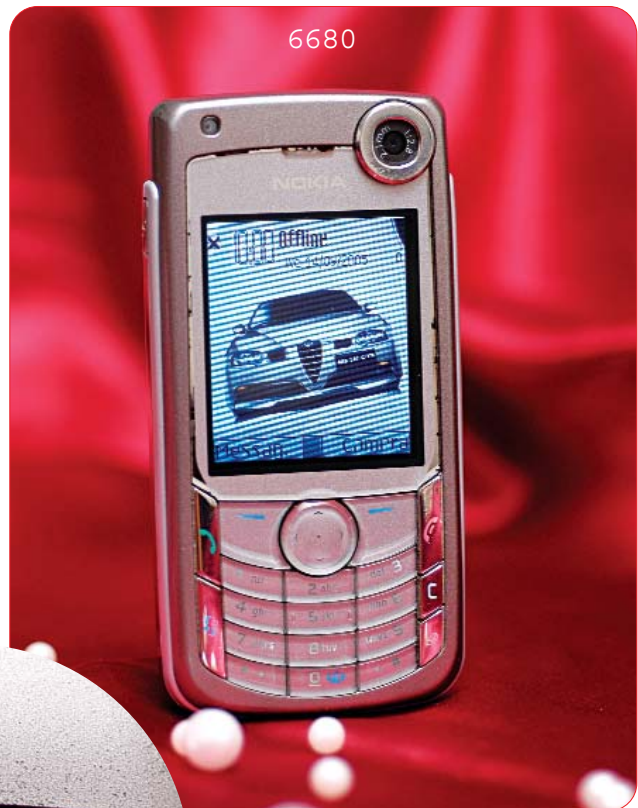
These cosmetically identical twins from Nokia push up its venerable smartphone line a notch above the rest. The Nokia 6680, the elder sibling, offers more features and is priced accordingly. Apart from some niche features, these two phones are identical in looks as well as performance.

Aesthetically, both phones have a bland and unappealing look. We did rather like the looks of the older 6630, 3G-enabled smartphone better. The 6680 comes in a pale blue colour with dabs of chrome and plastic thrown in on the front face that make this phone look cheap. The 6681, on the other hand, looks slightly better in its silver outfit despite the chrome treatment it has received.

Though the keys on the keypad are of reasonable size, they aren't inspiring due to the lack of proper tactile feedback. Moreover, due to the use of transparent plastic keys, the backlight doesn't help much.

The 262K colour display screens present on both these phones are a delight to work with. They are crisp, render colour perfectly and have a good resolution of 176 x 208 pixels. Nokia has also added a light sensor that automatically reduces or boosts the brightness according to ambient light conditions—which should improve the battery life. The screens were perfectly legible, both, indoors and outdoors.

The Nokia 6680, being 3G-capable, is provided with two camera sensors—one in the front and the other, at the back. The standard 1.3 mp camera, placed on the back panel, is protected by a slider mechanism, which when opened, automatically powers the camera mode. The other 0.3 mp camera on the front is placed at the upper right



hand corner and can be used for video conferencing. Since the 6681 isn't 3G capable, it doesn't need two cameras. It has the same 1.3 mp camera at the back with slider protection design as in the 6680.

The quality of photos taken by both phones is amazingly good—minimum noise and perfect colour rendition. Videos are good, but don't expect too much. The small LED flash isn't powerful enough and hence, effective at shorter distances only. Both phones are bundled with Photoshop Lite edition software. Due to unavailability of 3G support from providers, we couldn't test the video conferencing feature.

The UI is driven by the familiar Series-60 platform and comes with the usual software bundle. This time around, Nokia has fitted both phones with better processors, and it shows! The bundled PIM and e-mail application has improved a lot and is now much simpler to use.

The 6680 has 10 MB internal memory, while the 6681 has just 8 MB. Both phones come bundled with 64 MB RS-MMC card for those additional games one might be interested in. A memory slot on the side of the phone makes them hot swappable—a much better approach.

Both phones are also tri-band capable and support GPRS and EDGE for high data connection. Both have Bluetooth and USB 2.0 via a Nokia proprietary pop port for short range communication. Battery life remains the same—two to three days with nominal usage.

The Nokia 6681 is priced at Rs 18,500, whereas the 6680 retails for Rs 24,000. Under the present conditions in India, with no 3G support from cellular providers it will be wise to opt for the 6681 over the 3G-ready 6680.